

LEADERSHIP -- THE ART OF TRANSCENDING FRUSTRATION

My most beloved friends, I greet you with divine blessings, and I speak to you with the deepest joy to once again help you in your great endeavor to reach the security, the peace, and the ecstasy of your innermost soul, the source of all life, the source of all being. We are gathered here together for this immense purpose of bringing into this realm of matter and duality a new vibratory force and a new unity of consciousness. The importance, in terms of evolution as well as in terms of your own development, cannot be measured in human concepts. I can only ask you again and again to tune into the deeper meaning of your path and of your community you are in the process of creating. Feel the importance of this endeavor.

We speak constantly on your path about the importance of opening up, of giving up your defenses, your brittle hardness with which you think to protect yourself. In the open, vulnerable state, you fear to be susceptible to negative experience that may come to you from outside. At the same time, you also realize now that beauty, love, truth, and wisdom can also be taken in from the outside, so that as long as your defenses are intact, you also prevent yourself from taking these in. This explains why you often experience that life or people actually give to you the best and most longed-for gifts, but you find yourself unable to take them in.

However, opening up works in two directions -- not only toward the outside world. When you open up, you also make it possible to let out what comes from the deepest levels within. Because the negativities are in themselves a more subtle protective layer and bar the perfection of your inner being, they must surface first. But beyond them, the most positive, creative reality that you are can and will emerge when you commit yourself to be fully open and undefended.

You erroneously assume that in this open state you cannot protect yourself against abuse. Nothing could be further from the truth. Only when your higher self functions; when you are free from self-serving, selfish attitudes; when you are true to your inborn integrity and decency; when you follow the divine laws of the universe -- which are laws of justice, truth, wisdom, and love -- can you be strong enough for real, genuine protection, assertion, confrontation. Only then can you be free from guilt and therefore from anxiety and insecurity, from confusion and fear, which are the only reason for not being able to defend yourself against abuse.

When you speak and think of opening up, of dropping your defenses, conceive of this act not only as directed toward the outside, but primarily as an opening inward. Have the courage and faith in your deepest perfection so that you can trustingly allow the overlayers of the lower self to emerge in order for you to deal with and transform them.

Anyone developed enough to be capable of pursuing such a demanding path as this is also capable of immense fulfillment and joy -- and of leadership! In this path we are creating new leaders

in many fields, in many directions, in many ways. The purification you undergo makes you truly capable of genuine leadership in the best sense. Now let us discuss the meaning of leadership in the truest sense. And let us discuss your attitude toward leadership -- the leadership of others as well as eventually your own. You have many conflicting reactions toward leadership in yourself and in others. Let us start with your conflicting attitudes and then turn to the true meaning of leadership.

In your conflicting attitude you primarily envy leadership in others. You are competitive and envious of it. You often conceal this feeling from yourself and then resent it. Subsequently you are quite efficient in creating cases that are supposed to substantiate and justify your very unjustified feelings and thoughts. You reactivate, often unnecessarily, your old, already obsolete authority problem. Anyone who is a leader in the truest sense of the word becomes your enemy, and you believe that this is truth, that the leader is out to punish and deprive you.

Since you envy the leaders, you also want to be a leader. Yet in this childish, undeveloped part of yourself that is often allowed to overshadow the developed part, you do not want to assume the responsibilities that go with leadership. So you have here a very painful conflict and a dichotomy. On the one hand, you resent and envy it and battle against it in others; on the other hand, you want it for yourself without fulfilling the basic prerequisites. Then you resent the truer leaders for "taking it away from you" or for not "giving you" the same prerogatives. You make no movement toward or commitment to assuming the attitudes that constitute leadership. You can perhaps begin to see, my friends, the absurdity of this position. Yet it is an extremely frequent one, and once you are aware of it in yourself, you will not find it difficult to recognize it when it emerges again in you or in others around you.

There is still another conflicting attitude here. You want a leader for your own benefit -- someone who is so strong and powerful and benignly disposed toward you and exclusively concerned with your lower self desires that you can indulge in every destructive action or attitude without facing the consequences. This great leader, more like a personal, biased god, is supposed to magically alter the life stream and the life laws for your benefit. This figure should give you all the privileges without "demanding" from you love, giving, sense of responsibility, fairness, integrity, and so on. When you really examine the significance of some of your reactions, you will easily see that I do not exaggerate here. This is a quite accurate description of your irrational demands that you busily try to justify.

You have your terms for this phenomenon. You call it "transference," or making this super-figure your parents. But these terms easily become labels that lose their meaning. Parent or no parent, as long as you do not fulfill the natural prerequisites for leadership in your own right, in whatever fashion, you have no right to envy and resent leadership in others. Your cases have no justification in that state.

If you do not first assume leadership for your own life, naturally you will need a leader who takes on the governing of your life. No one can exist without leadership. You are then like a boat without a rudder. Someone must lead your life, someone must govern it, so if you do not choose to do so, others will have to do so to a degree. On a neurotic level, you will ask for it in ways that cannot be given you. But you will also ask for the freedom and the privileges which only self-leadership can confer. So you want others to lead you where it is convenient for you, but you will also resent them for it. Thus you are torn apart by many conflicts.

The question now is, are you really still in such an undeveloped, immature inner state that you require others to lead you? Or are you perhaps much more ready to be a leader in your own right? You can start with your own life and from there go on to take the full responsibility for your planetary citizenship, for being a bringer-in of the new age. This leadership can take many different forms. But it must begin in apparently invisible, unnoticed attitudes toward yourself and your immediate environment. It must begin with very simple little steps, above and beyond the self-responsibility we usually talk about and work with again and again.

I should like to explore here a few other such attitudes. Often, my dearest, most beloved friends, I see you stay in attitudes that you truly have outgrown. And that is really very damaging. When you have not outgrown a childish, negative attitude, but you are dealing with it, then the harm is not great. When you are still battling with it as you are learning about it and its ramifications, when you are discovering it on ever deeper levels and discovering the variety and subtlety with which these traits can manifest, then you are exactly where you need to be. But all too often you disclaim the truth that you are indeed much further in your development and no longer in a position in which you have to act out again and again attitudes that belonged to you years ago, or even perhaps months ago; but these months are, in terms of spiritual measurements, lifetimes. Yet you insist by old habit to stay and stay and stay where you no longer belong. You do not consider that you may indeed have outgrown your jealousies, your competitiveness, your ungivingness, your selfishness, your lack of concern, your unlovingness, your blaming, and your resenting others for the results of your own ungivingness.

This, my dearest friends, you have to ask yourself. You are now well in the position of recognizing such negativities, but you often fail to question yourself, do you really have to be there still? When I say these words, it may sound as if you had not moved and developed and grown. You have grown so much; and many past negativities no longer exist; and much more honesty and self-awareness does exist; and as a consequence there is much more love among you than ever before. But precisely because of this growth, the remaining stagnancies have heavier impact and more serious repercussions. This is a law of growth. Can you perhaps now make a different choice whenever the old negative reactions still recur?

Now let us discuss what leadership means. You envy leadership so much, you resent it so much, because you act as though others who are in a position of leadership deprived you of something or impose something on you that is unfair. You act as though you were being prevented from executing your own capacity to be a true leader. A leader, in the best sense of the word, has to, above anything else, want to give unselfishly -- not just theoretically and in principle while in practical life pettiness, ungivingness, and selfishness are expressed and even all too often denied and projected, but unselfish giving must exist really and truly in the smallest acts. If you do not want to give unselfishly, you cannot assert your own leadership. If you give grudgingly and unwilling because you pretend it is demanded of you, it cannot be called giving.

In another sense, true giving is demanded of you, for if you want the privileges of leadership -- and there are many -- that is the price: giving. The laws of life and creation always "demand," if you will, that they be obeyed because they have been created in perfection. Yet you act as if this were an unfair price, and you are full of outraged rebellion and resentments for which you often manage to find justification. You give only with second thoughts, ulterior motives, calculating inner bargains,

open little back doors, and a great deal of begrudging, so that it is no longer giving. Your giving is no longer giving, and therefore it leaves others and you empty. When you take the next step and say, "You see, I gave, and what do I get from it?" you negate the fact that your giving was never giving in the first place. Thus you cunningly reinforce your resistance to giving.

Giving is a very simple act which includes also the thought and the intentionality behind the act. In true giving, you state this: "I want to be an instrument of divine reality to enrich the world outside through the divinity that wants to express itself through me. I want to do this not for my ego aggrandizement nor for any other ulterior motive or advantage." That thought, that attitude, will actually bring you many advantages. It will give you the self-esteem and also the feeling of deserving and claiming the abundance you desperately grope for in faulty ways. That attitude must prevail as an underlying, overall, and all-permeating inner climate. When that attitude exists, jealousy cannot possibly exist any longer. The other person's giving and values can never detract from your own; you will know this and experience it.

If your giving is faked, neither anyone else's giving nor life's abundance can be received by you. At the same time, other people's true giving and the appreciation, the abundance in material and emotional goods they receive for it, will fill you with envy. That in itself can be a measurement for you where you are in regard to true giving. True giving is an act of love, of course. And if you do not love and if you do not wish to learn to love, you cannot fulfill your deepest yearning.

You may pray for being able to give and love, but you may be blind to the little areas where you demonstrate the opposite in subtle little ways in your reactions toward your fellow creatures. So leadership in its real sense is built on the love of true giving and on the true giving of love. Nothing can go wrong when that attitude exists. Perfect balance will be attained in all the many dichotomies and conflicts, in all the apparent difficulties of decisions your dualistic life seems to consist of.

Another quality extremely necessary for the leadership that is awaiting many of you -- many of you -- is the ability to be impartial and objective. That ability is still often very much lacking in my dearest friends. All too often you refuse to see your personal stake and desires in an issue, and you build justifications around your personal, tainted desires. You claim objectivity and impartiality when nothing could be further from the truth. If you lack this ability, the next best step that will bring you toward the more advanced state of objective detachment and that, in fact, is already a manifestation of this state to a degree, as well as an indispensable prerequisite of it, is the awareness of this partiality, the admitting of it, and thus disqualifying yourself from arguing the case in question. Admit how you bend reality according to your own emotional desires and colorations. By now, as a result of your practice in self-honesty, this should be possible for most of you. Your pathwork trains you for this highly advanced state of honesty and fairness. You can by now quite easily admit how you have a stake in certain assumptions and do not want to believe differently. And you may quite often do this. Yet, practically in the same breath, you also claim that you are nevertheless objective. That is not possible, my friends. Truly, it is not possible. For when you are blinded by self-interest and self-righteousness, by resentments and demands, by fear and guilt, by coveting and jealousy, by all sorts of negative feelings and thoughts, your assessments are not and cannot be objective.

It is truly a sign of greatness to know that you are, in this or that area, full of disturbing, turbulent emotions, full of conflict, and cannot therefore form an opinion. By doing so, you make a

great step toward your liberation and toward developing the capacity to become a trustworthy, reliable leader. It is the only way to form reliable assessments of others, to be really objective. A leader must have this greatness. But your stake in explaining and fashioning distorted reality is a tremendous hurdle that will make you very vulnerable. And if you have already attained in some manner a position of leadership, you can be toppled by the lack of this impartiality. Not admitting it, and claiming that you are free from personal stakes in proclaiming your opinions makes you very vulnerable. You must then guard your position because you then claim an unrightful position of leadership.

The ability to know your coloration of reality (as I implied in connection with some previous issues) and then to voluntarily disqualify yourself is a sign of maturity and greatness that will indeed bring you to an ever growing capacity to perceive reality as it really is, and know it and state it without fear, and be true to it even if it may expose you to criticism. Strength, self-trust, and security come as a result of the honesty to know and admit when you are not impartial and do not wish to be. We may state it thus: You can have the objectivity of knowing that you are not objective.

Another quality of leadership is the willingness to risk exposure and criticism. If you fear this and guard against it and yet grab for leadership because you like the advantage of it, the power and prestige, then again you defeat the purpose. You create a painful conflict in yourself, and you create frustration. True leadership cannot exist under these circumstances for which you may then again blame the outer world and those who, at least in some respects, have rightfully attained leadership, whether you want to admit and see this or not.

So if you cannot bear the momentary pain of being misunderstood, criticized -- rightly or wrongly -- then you do not have the firm foundation necessary for a true leader. Leadership means constant risk. If you do not wish to take this risk, how can you claim a case for yourself in your jealousies, in your resentments, in your rebellion toward those who assume the responsibilities of leadership with all that this implies?

Still another absolutely essential quality of leadership that the infant or the infantile personality lacks and is unwilling to even consider is the attitude toward frustration. Of course we have discussed this before in previous lectures, but again and again I see so many of you being blind to what is going on because you do not acknowledge your anger and fury when something does not go your way. And I want to spend a little more time on this all important topic.

True unification and wholeness of the personality can only come when the dichotomy of frustration versus fulfillment has been conciliated. Now how can it be conciliated when one of the dualities is being fought against and the other grabbed at? If you have a very strong "I must have it," on the one hand, and an equally strong "I must not have it" for the opposite of what is desired, on the other, you are in a state of painful duality. You erroneously attempt to reduce the tension of this painful state by pressuring life into giving you the fulfillment of the desire by eliminating all frustration. Thus you never learn how to really transcend frustration so that it will no longer occur. Of course you never succeed in this attempt and only become more frustrated. You can be sure that as long as you experience frustration, you have to learn from it. Generally speaking, this is your position in regard to frustration.

Now what kind of approach would be fruitful toward frustration and would eventually lead to its transcendence? And when I speak of transcendence, I do not mean a false transcendence of making yourself so disconnected from your feelings that you simply do not know how tense, anxious, and desirous you are. I mean a very genuine transcendence that is highly alive, conscious, and dynamic, full of feelings that flow harmoniously with the stream of life. There are some steps in the attainment of this state.

The first step on this particular ladder would be: "If it is painful or undesirable, I will trust it anyway. I will trust my faculties to bear it, to relax into it, to learn from it, to handle it and make the best of it. I will learn a lesson from this particular frustration and will not act as if it were a catastrophe. Perhaps it is not a catastrophe, perhaps something good can come from it." That very open attitude is the first step that will bring you almost at once into a new state of highly reduced anxiety and highly increased security. For your anxiety is fostered by your dependence on something that cannot be and by your assumption that you have to manipulate reality around you to suit the most infantile misconceptions and unreal needs for instant gratification; by your assumption that everything has to be exactly according to your momentary, very limited vision that is totally cut off from the sequence of cause and effect in your life and in universal life. So the first step is to make room for relaxing your reaction of utter disgust and outrage about frustration, your fear and anger about it; to challenge and question this reaction; and to consider it as being possibly faulty and erroneous. Thereby you make room for new faculties in you: the faculty that you can perhaps allow things to happen; the faculty that you find a new strength and wisdom to deal with something that does not bend according to your self-will. This gives immense self-confidence and self-reliance that constant obedience to your self-will could never confer on you. This is a very important first step, my dearest ones. It is the first step that leads to a much more beautiful one.

The next step on the ladder of learning to transcend frustration is the active, deliberate, and renewed search for the meaning of that particular frustration. What does the particular frustration you are dealing with at this time have to teach you? For as I said, and I deliberately repeat it, there is no frustration that does not contain a joyful, valuable, liberating lesson for you. Most of the time you are completely unwilling to consider such a possibility. You are so bent on battling the occurrence of frustration that the lesson gets lost and you pass by a valuable mark on your path, a high mark, an opportunity. And you create new necessities for such opportunities that are inevitable to come. They must come no matter how you battle against them. The more you battle against them, the more rigid you will become, the worse the frustration will appear, the more the frustrations will grow in size, intensity, and significance until they overwhelm you. In the overwhelming, there may be a chance that you discover the illusion you have created that frustration is an enemy. The overwhelming has the capacity to loosen up the tightness against frustration and consequently against all of life.

Frustration is a friend, my friends. You can make it a friend by courageously and intelligently wishing to explore its meaning and allowing it to be your teacher and your therapist, as it were.

This will bring you to the next step on this ladder, which is the discovery of the meaning. He who knocks shall be opened, he who searches must find. The answer, the meaning, will always astound you. The wisdom of it, the realization of how necessary this lesson is, what you gain from it in new strength, wisdom, liberation will already alter your outlook toward frustration so that when another such lesson comes you will be much less afraid of it, much more confident of its

meaningfulness for you, and much less resistant to repeat those steps. It will give you a new trust in life and a new vision of the consciousness behind all things, even behind the frustration you have battled against. This is obviously a substantial step toward conciliating the dichotomy of frustration versus fulfillment.

The further step on the ladder brings you into a much deeper, more subtle, and more radiant world. When you have passed the previous steps, you can begin to practice something very beautiful. You know, at least theoretically, that the reality of God exists in every fraction of second in time, in every fraction of measurement, in every fraction of experience in everything that is, whether it be an entity, a being, a creation, an object, an experience, or whatever. Divine reality in its grandiose joyous truth and aliveness and meaningfulness and purposefulness lives in everything that is, that ever was, and that ever will be. I have said these words before. I deliberately repeat them here, for they apply to frustration as well. As you approach frustration through the steps I have proposed here, the point of the frustration will narrow. You will perhaps be able to focus into it in a meditative attuning and let yourself fully experience that point of frustration after you have learned the lesson it has to teach. Flow with it, go with it, accept it, embrace it. Completely reverse your attitude from rejecting, to accepting it. And what you will experience will surpass your imagination. You will discover in its deepest one-pointedness the divinity of life, the divinity of a particular frustration. And it will no longer be a frustration. It will become the highest fulfillment imaginable, much more so than the fulfillment you craved for, away from the frustration.

That, of course, my beloved friends, is the point where you have overcome frustration, where you have mastered and truly transcended it -- not transcended in the false way of denying your frustrated feelings, and pretending that you do not mind it on the mask-self level, but truly overcome it. Not only will you no longer fear frustration, not only do you now know that you can deal with it, that you have the equipment and the capacities and the resources and the creativity to deal with it; you also have utilized it as a beautiful lesson and consequently coming to the divinity of it, where it is all one, where there is God and fulfillment within the frustration.

This is your road, my friends. This is what many of you now need on your path. Now I am not saying that every leader in this world who is a rightful leader in the positive sense has totally transcended frustration in this way. But I will say that to the degree true leadership exists, the attitude toward frustration is in most instances a fairly mature and realistic one, and there is no longer an attitude of outraged insult when frustration is felt.

Now when you free yourself of these impediments, of selfishness, of insistence to never experience frustration, of unlovingness and ungivingness, of ego aggrandizement, of jealousy and resentments, then you have removed major obstructions to your fulfillment. You still go around, at times, my friends, commiserating about this or that unhappiness or unfulfillment; and you choose not to connect with those very attitudes I talk about here. They are the creators of your unfulfillment and frustrations: your unlovingness, your selfishness, your lack of impartiality, your bias and one-sidedness, your outrage when you meet frustration. With your unwillingness to expose yourself to the possibility of being frustrated, you limit your life to very narrow confines and make yourself unnecessarily vulnerable in a brittle way.

Happiness means many things. It means all these things I discuss here. When you have come to your own resources, to your own inner greatness because these lessons are being learned, you

must be in one way or another a leader. Leadership does not always take the form of visible outer manifestation. It also exists in more subtle ways. In fact it almost always begins in more subtle, unnoticeable ways. But you will be an authority in your own right in the best sense of the word. You cannot be that unless you reconsider the attitudes I have mentioned, and your jealousies and envies appear as the painful illusions they really are. But still all too often you take them seriously. You do not acknowledge having them and you justify them. You act as if others who have more authority took it away from you.

So I implore you, my dearest friends, be where you really can be now. Shed these unnecessary attitudes. It is time for many of you. You have acknowledged and faced some of these attitudes. It is time to let them go. I said as much to some of my dearest friends some time ago. It is time to repeat this message. Let this lecture deeply go into you. Heed it, use it, make it the help it is meant to be. You have nothing but joy and gain to expect from doing so. Your good will, your serious attempt to become who you are already in this respect is now truly possible. You think that the person you can be has not been born yet, but he or she is already waiting to be released when you let go and open yourself up to what wants to emerge from within you. It is only the outer, separated, obsolete part of the self that still takes such dominance because your willful personality allies itself with this, rather than with what is so much stronger and so much more real and ready to emerge into manifestation.

Let me part from you in manifestation only. For I am always here, close to you and loving every one of you dearly and deeply, as we all do in our world, who are so concerned with the beautiful creation you are part of. So I say, be blessed, rejoice, and have faith that your life is a glory and will be a more and more glorious fulfillment. Be blessed my beloved ones.

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